

Chkobba — Corrected Developer Game Specification

1. Quick Summary

Chkobba is a Tunisian capture-card game derived from Scopa, played with a 40-card Italian/Spanish style deck. Players capture cards either by exact rank match or by exact-sum addition. A player scores a chkobba point whenever they clear the entire table during play, except on the final capture of the game. At the end of the manche, four additional scoring categories are evaluated.

2. Deck, Values, and Terminology

Deck composition:

- 40 cards total
- 4 suits: spades, hearts, diamonds, clubs
- Ranks: 1-7 plus three face cards

Numeric values:

- Ace = 1
- 2-7 = face value
- Dame = 8
- Valet = 9
- Roi = 10

Special scoring card:

- 7 of diamonds (Sab⁷ a l-⁷ayya)

3. Setup and Dealing

Supported modes:

- 2 players
- 2 teams of 2 players
- 3-4 independent players (optional)

Initial deal procedure:

1. One player shuffles.
2. Opponent cuts and draws one card.
3. Opponent may either:
 - keep the drawn card, or
 - place it face-up on the table.

If the cutter keeps the card:

- dealer gives 2 more cards to cutter
- dealer receives 3 cards
- 4 cards placed on table

If the cutter places the card on table:

- dealer gives 3 cards to each player
- 4 cards placed on table

After dealing:

- every player has 3 cards
- table contains 4 cards

Redeal rule:

If the initial table layout contains three cards of identical rank, the entire deal is void and must be redealt.

The deck is redealt in packets of 3 cards until exhausted. There are six total deals per manche.

4. Turn Rules and Captures

Players take turns playing one card.
Passing is not allowed.

A player is NOT forced to capture.
The player may choose any legal card from hand.

Capture methods:

A) Match Capture

- played card exactly matches rank of table card
- both cards are captured

B) Addition Capture

- exactly ONE played card is used
- played card value must equal exact sum of table cards
- players may not combine multiple hand cards

Example:

- playing 8 may capture table cards 7+1

Priority rule:

If a chosen played card can capture both:

- by exact rank match
- and by addition

then exact rank match is mandatory.

Multiple combinations:

If several valid addition combinations exist,
the player must explicitly choose one combination.
Only the chosen combination is captured.

If no capture is made:

- played card remains on table

End-of-manche rule:

All remaining table cards go to the player who made the final successful capture.

Remaining table cards do NOT count as a chkobba.

5. Chkobba and Scoring

Chkobba:

Whenever a capture empties the entire table,
the player immediately gains 1 chkobba point.

Exception:

No chkobba is awarded on the final capture of the manche.

Implementation suggestion:

mark the chkobba capture card face-up in the capture pile.

End-of-manche points:

1. K♠r♠a

- most captured cards
- worth 1 point
- ties give no point

2. D♠n♠r♠

- most diamonds
- worth 1 point
- ties give no point

3. Barm♠la / Primera

Evaluation order:

1. compare number of 7s
2. if tied, compare number of 6s
3. if still tied, no point

4. Sab♠a l-♠ayya

- player holding 7♦ gains 1 point

Final manche score:

- chkobba points earned during play
- PLUS

- end-of-manche category points

Typical match targets:

- 11
- 21
- 31

6. Recommended Data Structures

```
Card:
{
  suit: 'hearts' | 'spades' | 'diamonds' | 'clubs',
  rank: 1..10,
  label: string,
  short: string
}

Player:
{
  id,
  hand: Card[],
  captures: Card[],
  chkobbaFaceups: Card[],
  chkobbaCount: number
}

GameState:
{
  deck,
  players,
  table,
  dealerIndex,
  currentPlayerIndex,
  scores,
  targetScore
}
```

7. Suggested Core Functions

```
initDeck()
• create and shuffle 40-card deck

dealInitial()
• implement cut/keep logic
• validate redeal condition

findCaptures()
• return:
  • match captures
  • addition captures

playCard()
• validate turn legality
• apply selected capture

applyCapture()
• move captured cards
• detect chkobba

endMancheScoring()
• compute all category points
• apply chkobba totals
```

8. Suggested Unit Tests

1. Deal validation
 - verify hand/table counts
 - verify redeal condition
2. Match priority

- table contains Dame and 7+1
 - played Dame must capture Dame
3. Addition capture
 - played 8 captures 7+1
 4. Multiple addition combinations
 - player explicitly selects valid combination
 5. Chkobba detection
 - table cleared mid-manche
 6. Final trick validation
 - no chkobba awarded
 7. Final scoring
 - verify all category calculations

9. Example Sequence

Table:

[6♣, Valet♠, 7♥, 3♦]

Player hand:

[Valet♣, 2♦, Roi♥]

Player plays Valet♣:

- exact rank match captures Valet♠
- both cards move to capture pile